CREATIVE DIST

QUICK GUIDE

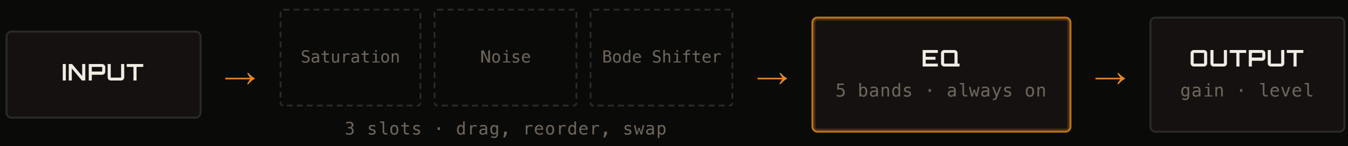
A creative saturator for your DAW: three interchangeable modules, a 5-band EQ, and an output stage that never lets you break the signal.

CREATIVE SOUND — VST3 / AU PLUGIN — VERSION 1.0.0

HOW IT'S BUILT

What's inside the plugin

Creative Dist is built around **three interchangeable modules** — Saturation, Noise, and Bode Shifter — that you choose, reorder, and combine freely across three drag-and-drop slots. The signal then passes through an always-on **5-band EQ**, and finally through an **output** stage that keeps the level in check before it leaves the plugin.



Any slot can hold any of the three modules — or stay empty. You can use the same module twice, drag it to reorder the chain, and listen to any module **in isolation** (parallel to whatever comes after it) with that module's PAR button.

ALWAYS ON, BEHIND THE SCENES

You won't find a knob for these — they work on their own, so you can experiment without risking a broken signal: **Auto Gain** (compensates level as you push Drive), **DC blocking**, a **Silence Gate** at −120dB, **BassProtect** (shields the low end from heavy saturation), and **HarshnessGuard** (tames the harshest highs). And right at the end of the chain, an asymptotic **Soft Clip** always keeps you under 0dBFS.

THE TOP BAR

Presets, undo, bypass

`Preset ▸◂` Step through presets with the arrows, or open the full searchable list from the dropdown.

`Save / Load` Save the current preset (with an overwrite prompt) or import one from a file.

`Folder` Choose where your presets are saved, or reset to the default folder next to the plugin.

`Dice` Randomize every active module at once — a great way to find a starting point.

`Undo` Step back one action on knobs or EQ if a change doesn't work out.

`Bypass` Turn off the whole plugin (passthrough) to compare against the original signal.

MODULE 1 OF 3

Saturation

DISTORTION

The heart of the saturation: pushes the signal through a distortion curve, with 14 different characters to choose from.

`Drive` How hard the signal is pushed into the curve — higher means more saturation.

`Mix` How much saturated signal you hear blended with the clean signal.

`Dyn Resp` Makes Drive react in real time to the input signal's envelope.

`Asymmetry` Makes the curve asymmetric between the positive and negative half-cycles: more even harmonics, a more organic color.

THE 14 MODES (WAVE TYPE)

01 `Tube` — warm, smooth valve-style saturation

02 `Soft Clip` — gentle, musical peak compression

03 `Asym` — asymmetric curve, lively color

04 `Diode` — biting, diode-style edge

05 `Overdrive` — smooth, guitar-style overdrive

06 `Hard Clip` — sharp, direct clipping

07 `Linear` — no distortion, clean reference

08 `Digital` — jagged clip, deliberately lo-fi

09 `Foldback` — the signal folds back on itself

10 `Sine` — sinusoidal waveshaping

11 `Bitcrush` — reduces bit depth, retro

12 `Downsample` — reduces sample rate, retro

13 `X-Shaper` — pure cubic curve, predictable color

14 `Dual Shaper` — Tube + Soft Clip in series

MODULE 2 OF 3

Noise

TEXTURE

Adds a bed of noise to the signal: from a thin veil to a texture in the foreground.

Amount Amount of noise blended into the signal.

HP / LP High-pass and low-pass filters that shape the noise's color.

Pitch Transposes the noise up to ±32 semitones.

Loop / 1-Shot Loop: the noise runs continuously. 1-Shot: it restarts on every incoming transient, like a small burst synced to the sound.

White Noise	full spectrum, even across all frequencies
Pink Noise	more low-end energy, soft and natural sound
Brown Noise	even darker, deep and muffled
Vinyl Crackle	record-style crackle, analog imperfections
Digital Noise	digital noise, colder and more "computerized"

MODULE 3 OF 3

Bode Shifter

FREQUENCY

Not a pitch shifter: shifts the entire spectrum by a fixed amount in Hz, creating metallic, inharmonic tones — with a built-in feedback delay.

Frequency How far (in Hz) the spectrum is shifted — the range setting sets the knob's scale.

Delay Time The feedback loop's delay time; the BPM button syncs it to the DAW's tempo in musical values.

Feedback How much shifted/delayed signal feeds back into the loop — higher means more cascades and movement.

Mix Dry/wet between the original and the frequency-shifted signal.

Every module also has a PAR (Parallel) button: it isolates that module from the rest of the chain, so you hear it "clean" instead of reprocessed by whatever comes after it.

ALWAYS ON

5-band EQ

The EQ never switches off — **it's always active**, which is why it has no on/off switch. Five bands: **Low Cut** and **High Cut** (with adjustable slope) plus three **bells** (frequency, gain, Q) — all draggable directly on the curve.

`Pre / Post` The EQ works before or after the three modules — two independent settings, switch with one click.

`Linear Phase` Switches the engine from a classic IIR filter to a linear-phase (FIR) one: more transparent, at the cost of some latency.

`Mix` Dry/wet for the whole EQ section.

`Oversampling` Off / 2X / 4X — turn it up if you hear aliasing on the more aggressive saturation modes.

FINAL STAGE

Output

`Input Gain` Sets the level before it enters the chain — useful for pushing the saturation modules harder (or softer).

`Level` The plugin's output volume.

`Soft Clip` Not a button — a light. It lights up when the safety limiter is working to keep the output under 0dBFS.

GETTING STARTED

Five practical tips

01 Start with **Mix at 100%** and Drive low: it's easier to judge a saturation's character when it isn't blended with the clean signal. Lower the Mix only after you've picked a mode.

02 Use **PAR (Parallel)** on a module to A/B the processed and original signal without leaving the plugin.

03 If an aggressive mode — **Digital, Bitcrush, Hard Clip** — sounds unpleasantly harsh, turn **Oversampling** up to 2X or 4X in the EQ before switching modes.

04 Module order matters: drag **Noise before Saturation** to have it distort along with the signal, or leave it after — with PAR on — to keep it clean and separate.

05 The red **SOFT CLIP** light isn't an error: it's the safety net that keeps you under 0dBFS on the way out, no matter what you do upstream.

IN ONE SENTENCE

Three modules to combine, an EQ that's always ready, an output that has your back: **explore without fear of breaking the signal.**